

The 12 Contract Clauses to Check Before You Sign

Check each box as you review your contract. Flag any clause you don't understand.

- ☐ **1 Non-compete clause**
Scope, duration, and geography — is it enforceable in your state?
- ☐ **2 Mandatory arbitration**
Waives your right to sue in court or join a class action.
- ☐ **3 IP assignment**
Who owns work you create — during or outside business hours?
- ☐ **4 At-will employment**
Can you be fired without cause or notice?
- ☐ **5 Auto-renewal**
Hidden re-enrollment that charges you past your intended end date.
- ☐ **6 Limitation of liability**
Cap on damages — is it one-sided against you?
- ☐ **7 Indemnification**
Who pays if something goes wrong, and for what?
- ☐ **8 Governing law & jurisdiction**
Which state's laws apply, and where disputes are resolved.
- ☐ **9 Notice & termination**
How much notice is required, and under what conditions.
- ☐ **10 Non-solicitation**
Restrictions on hiring ex-colleagues or contacting past clients.
- ☐ **11 Exclusivity clause**
Can you work with competitors, freelance, or take side projects?
- ☐ **12 Liquidated damages**
Fixed penalty clauses — are they proportionate and enforceable?

Found a clause you don't understand?

Upload your contract at contrivox.com — plain-English analysis in 60 seconds.